PCI Plus

Frequently Asked Questions

Is PCI compliance mandatory?

The Payment Card Industry's Data Security Standards (PCI-DSS) were implemented by the card brands to help merchants protect their credit and debit card payment systems from cybercriminal intrusions and the theft of cardholder information. They are governed by the PCI Security Standards Council.

Merchants must meet and maintain certain data management security requirements and confirm compliance on an annual basis to be considered compliant with PCI-DSS standards. Should a security breach and/or data compromise originate at a non-compliant merchant location, the card brands will likely impose significant fines and increased security requirements on the merchant, if they choose to remain in business.

Fortunately, we have solutions available that allow you to eliminate the expense and effort traditionally associated with maintaining PCI compliance. To see if you qualify, or if you've recently received news that your non-compliance fee has gone up, contact your Sales Partner at 866.485.8999.

What are PCI levels and how are they determined?

All merchants who accept credit, debit, and prepaid card payments are classified under a PCI Level. PCI levels are based on a merchant's annual volume of card transactions.

Level 1 — Merchants processing more than 6 million transactions annually across all channels.
Level 2 — Merchants processing 1 to 6 million transactions annually across all channels.
Level 3 — Merchants processing 20,000 to 1 million ecommerce transactions annually.
Level 4 — Merchants processing fewer than 20,000 ecommerce transactions annually and all other merchants processing up to 1 million transactions annually across all channels.

What is PCI Plus?

PCI Plus is our PCI compliance experience available to every merchant doing business with us. The program was designed to minimize the onerous requirements of completing annual PCI compliance paperwork and to prevent our merchants from accidentally becoming non-compliant due to an unintended delinquency.

PCI Plus is a frictionless, easy-to-manage compliance system that automates most, and in a majority of cases, all of a merchant's personal requirements. The program was created with your time and money in mind. You will be provided with the maximum level of PCI assurance and coverage possible, without the requirements of remembering to maintain annual compliance on your own.

How will I benefit from PCI Plus enrollment?

PCI Plus was designed to minimize the inconvenience of having to complete/submit annual PCI compliance paperwork and to prevent our merchants from accidentally becoming non-compliant due to an unintentional delinquency. With PCI Plus covering your account, you can rest easy, knowing your business compliance requirements are up-to-date and your account is being covered by our expert PCI Plus support team.

Many qualified merchants under PCI Plus pay minimal PCI program fees, have no ongoing administrative requirements, and benefit from our generous breach forgiveness program.

If you want to learn more about this frictionless, easy-to-manage PCI compliance system, and how you can leverage the maximum PCI compliance benefits we can offer to your business, please contact your Sales Partner to see what your business qualifies for.

How are my PCI Plus fees determined?

PCI Plus fees are determined by designated Tiers. Your business will be classified based on processing platform, equipment type, and pricing model. Please consult your merchant statement to see which Tier applies.

To learn whether your business qualifies for a no-fee or lower-fee PCI Plus option, please contact your Sales Partner.

Upfront & monthly frequency

Merchant* PCI tier	1st month merchant fee**	1st month compensation	Additonal months fee	Additonal months compensation	Annualized compensation
Tier I	**$145.00**	**$29.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$29.00**
Tier II	**$145.00**	**$29.00**	**$20.00**	**$3.00**	**$65.00**
Tier III	**$145.00**	**$29.00**	**$70.00**	**$2.00**	**$53.00**

*All multi-merchant discounts will be reflected in residual compensation
**All PCI compliance program fees start billing to merchants in month 4

Monthly-only frequency

Merchant PCI tier	Monthly merchant fee*	Monthly compensation	Annualized compensation
Tier I	**$15.00**	**$0.80**	**$9.60**
Tier II	**$37.00**	**$3.00**	**$36.00**
Tier III	**$85.00**	**$2.00**	**$24.00**

*All PCI compliance program fees start billing to merchants in month 4

How do I know if my business is currently PCI compliant?

New merchant accounts will be automatically enrolled in our PCI Plus program and the PCI Plus benefits for existing merchants will take effect December 2019.

Please refer to your billing statement to confirm your existing PCI Plus Tier status. If you are designated as a No Tier, Tier I, or Tier II merchant, you are fully compliant until your next PCI renewal date.

If you are designated as a Tier III merchant, be sure to contact us right away to learn what steps you will need to take to become compliant. Please contact our PCI Plus Care team at **866.485.8999** or email us at **pciplus@paymentshub.com** (please remember to include your business name and merchant ID number).

What should I do if my business is not currently PCI compliant?

Please refer to your billing statement to confirm your existing PCI Plus Tier status.

If you are designated as a Tier III merchant, be sure to contact our PCI Plus Care team right away to learn what steps you will need to take to achieve compliance. Call **866.485.8999** or email us at **pciplus@paymentshub.com** (please remember to include your business name and merchant ID number).

Can my business be compliant without completing annual SAQs?

Yes. Many merchants under our PCI Plus program are exempt from SAQs, scans, and check-in requirements. To learn more about these programs and what your business will qualify for, please contact your Sales Partner.

What is breach forgiveness?

Breach forgiveness is a feature of the PCI Plus program that provides many Level 3 and Level 4 merchants with a $100,000 exemption in reimbursement costs (per merchant ID) in the event of a data breach.

Does my business qualify for breach forgiveness?

- You must be a Level 3 or Level 4 merchant.
- **You cannot have a previous card brand fine or penalty** (PCI assessment) unless you have been reinstated based on completion of PCI certification (e.g. Self-Assessment Questionnaire).
- You haven't suffered a **prior breach** without PCI recertification.
- **The incident occurs, is discovered, and is reported** during the breach forgiveness program period (all expenses arising from the same incident or chain of related incidents at a merchant shall be considered a single incident). Note that the breach forgiveness program period renews each month based as long as you continue to meet criteria and as long as no exclusion applies.
- Qualifications to be reviewed by a PCI Plus representative to confirm merchant eligibility.

What is SecureTrust™ and who is TrustWave?

SecureTrust™ is an industry-leading, cloud-based information security platform, and a division of TrustWave, our PCI compliance partner. If your PCI Plus merchant Tier requires your business to undergo an SAQ with scanning requirements, these compliance steps will be facilitated by TrustWave for your business.

How soon is my business eligible for PCI Plus benefits?

New merchant accounts will be automatically enrolled in our PCI Plus program and the PCI Plus benefits for existing merchants take effect December 2019.

When will I be billed for PCI Plus?

Billing for newly boarded merchant accounts will begin in month four following account approval.

For existing merchants, the new PCI Plus monthly fees will initiate in December 2019. If the upfront billing option is selected, the merchant's new annual fee will be assessed at the PCI anniversary date, beginning with December 2019 anniversaries.

Merchants formerly on the annual fee plan will automatically convert to the PCI Plus Upfront billing plan in December 2019.

If you wish to change billing plans, contact us at **866.485.8999** to make your request (changes will take effect on the next anniversary date).

Is there more than one billing option?

Yes. To learn whether your business qualifies for a no-fee or lower-fee PCI Plus option, please contact your Sales Partner.

Other merchants* pay one, all-inclusive fee that covers everything needed to be PCI compliant. Depending on your merchant Tier classification, you will choose the Upfront (Tier I merchants) or Upfront (Tier II/III) option, or you can even bypass the Upfront fee and make only month-by-month payments.

Wish to change billing plans? Call **866.485.8999** to make your request and changes will take effect on your next PCI anniversary date.

*Non-compliant Global Payments merchants may also be assessed a $375 quarterly fee by Global Payments. Contact your Sales Partner to see if your business qualifies to avoid this fee by upgrading to our proprietary payments platform, Electronic Payment Exchange (EPX).

How do I change my billing plan?

Call 866.485.8999 to make your request and changes will take effect on your next PCI anniversary date.

Why did the annual PCI fee increase?

The PCI Plus program now provides your business with a comprehensive, frictionless program that will help to ensure that your business is compliant with PCI-DSS requirements and covered in the event of a data breach up to $100,000. While the costs are slightly higher than our former PCI compliance program, the benefits greatly outweigh our former program, and the current program will also save your business significant time and money associated when it comes to maintaining compliance on your own.

Multi-merchant discounts.

Merchants on upfront billing will receive discounts to their fee amounts for additional MIDs during month-4 billing:

Month 4, Tier I if compliant — $60
Month 4, Tier II if compliant — $95
Months 5-12 — tiers remain the same

Merchants on monthly billing will receive no discount.

Why am I being assessed an annual upfront fee and a monthly fee?

Merchants falling into Tier II/III, and enrolled in the Upfront billing option, will pay an annual fee on their renewal date, as well as subsequent monthly payments to help reduce the burden of paying the entire PCI expense at one time. Should you wish to pay only monthly or only annually, we have solutions that can accomplish this as well.

What do I do if I think I've been assessed incorrectly?

If you have questions or concerns about your merchant Tier or the fees being assessed to your account, please contact our PCI Plus Care team at 866.485.8999.

How do I qualify for lower PCI fees?

Many of our merchant Tiers pay no fees at all! To learn whether your business qualifies for a no-fee or lower-fee PCI Plus option, please contact your Sales Partner.

Merchants wishing to change billing plans should call us at 866.485.8999 to make your request and changes will take effect on your next PCI anniversary date.

How do I request different equipment?

We offer many different equipment options, including several which do not require you to pay PCI fees at all!

To learn whether your business qualifies for a no-fee or lower-fee PCI Plus option, please contact your Sales Partner.

Merchants wishing to change billing plans should contact us at 866.485.8999 to make your request and changes will take effect on your next PCI anniversary date.

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